Zachary Ryan

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EDUCATION

Robert Morris University — Pittsburgh, PA
Bachelor of Science in Cybersecurity — August 2024 - December 2026
Outstanding Cybersecurity Student Award [Link] | Dean's List Recipient — GPA: 3.91/4.0

Skills

Language/Scripting: Python | SQL | Bash |PowerShell | Java | HTML | CSS
Security Tools: CrowdStrike Falcon | Rapid7 | Azure | NinjaOne | Mimecast | Okta | Keeper | FreshService | Microsoft Defender
Technical: Linux | Docker | Git/GitHub | TCP/IP | Firewalls | Operating Systems | Digital Forensics | Network Segmentation
Security Operations: Vulnerability Management | Incident Response | Security Investigations | Ticket Triage | Access Control
Governance & Risk: TPRM | ISO/IEC 42001 | NIST AI RMF | Cyber Policy | Auditability | Risk Management

EXPERIENCE

Brixmor Property Group | Cybersecurity Intern | Philadelphia, PA — May 2026 - July 2026

- Triaged security tickets across a 500+ user enterprise using Freshservice, CrowdStrike, Rapid7, Umbrella, and Defender
- Performed Rapid7 vulnerability management on 25+ high-risk assets, documenting CVEs and remediation recommendations
- Assessed 100+ Cisco Umbrella domains, classified DNS risk, and recommended block/allow decisions
- Assisted with Third-Party Risk Management policy development for vendor onboarding, technology review, security documentation, control assessment, risk acceptance, compliance review, and vendor security evaluation workflows

United States Navy |Machinist Mate - Nuclear Reactor Department |Norfolk, VA — July 2020 - September 2023

- Monitored reactor support systems, logs, gauges, alarms, and indicators to detect abnormal operating conditions
- Diagnosed mechanical and reactor system abnormalities using technical manuals, schematics, and procedures
- Trained junior sailors on watchstanding duties, system knowledge, and qualification requirements
- Executed incident response procedures under strict safety, documentation, and operational requirements

PROJECTS

Policy-as-Code Docker Network Segmentation Lab | [Github]

- Designed a segmented enterprise network architecture with public, private, and management security zones
- Implemented policy-as-code controls and firewall rules to restrict unauthorized network access
- Developed automated testing and visualization tools to validate security policy compliance across network segments

AI Powered Phishing Email Detection & Safe Rewrite System |[Github]

- Built a full-stack phishing detection platform using FastAPI and React to classify emails by risk level
- Implemented explainable risk scoring using keyword analysis, links, and SPF/DKIM/DMARC authentication headers
- Developed a safe email rewrite engine that removes malicious content and highlights changes using HTML diff visualization

SOC-Style Network Anomaly Detection Lab | [GitHub]

- Built a full-stack SOC-style network anomaly detection platform using FastAPI, Docker, and React
- Implemented Isolation Forest machine learning to score and flag anomalous real-time network traffic
- Developed a traffic simulation engine generating normal traffic flows, attacker behavior, and port scan anomalies

PUBLICATIONS

Ryan, Z., & Mishra, S. (2026). ***Auditable Evidence in AI Cybersecurity Compliance: A Cross-Framework Analysis.***
Computers & Security (Submitted June 2026)

- Compared NIST AI RMF, ISO/IEC 42001, EU AI Act, CSA AICM, AWS, and Google Cloud security guidance
- Analyzed evidence gaps across documentation, logging, monitoring, access control, model security, and testing
- Evaluated how logs, access records, monitoring outputs, and assessment artifacts support cybersecurity compliance
- Identified gaps between AI security requirements, audit evidence, and assurance readiness across major frameworks

Ryan, Z., & Mishra, S. (2026). ***Evaluating AI vs Human Phishing Evasion Across Emulated Email Filters and SpamAssassin.***
NEDSI Annual Conference (Accepted; presented April 2026) [Publication Link – PDF pp. 189 - 202]

- Created controlled prompts to generate realistic AI phishing emails using dummy URLs and fictional identities
- Built a 1,260-email dataset comparing AI and human phishing across account, financial, and delivery themes
- Applied Chi-square and Z-tests showing AI phishing evaded selected emulated filters more often than human phishing emails
- Developed a Python-based filter emulation framework to score phishing emails, compare AI versus human bypass rates, evaluate provider-specific thresholds, and test emulated Gmail, Outlook, Yahoo, and SpamAssassin detection conditions

LICENSES AND CERTIFICATIONS

- DoD Secret Clearance | CompTIA Security+ (Scheduled) | Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate [Link]